

# Metaphor annotation: Instructions for Step 1

## Project: Metaphor and Inferential Meaning in Text Simplification

In this task, you will:

1. Read passages in the input file.
2. Identify inferential metaphors in each passage.
3. Record each metaphor span as a separate row in the output template file.

This phase focuses only on **identifying inferential metaphors in the original text**.  
You do not evaluate simplified versions at this stage.

Please work independently so that we can compute annotation agreement.  
Please do not use LLMs. Our research shows that they are not good at this task just yet.

## Files You Will Use

1. **Input File:** available in Google folders with your names. Example:  
`metaphor_selection_batch_01_1A_input.csv`

Columns:

- slug
- triplet\_id
- original\_sentence

You will read passages from this file.

## 2. Output Template

Example: `metaphor_selection_batch_01_1A_output_template.csv`

Columns:

- slug
- triplet\_id
- metaphor\_span
- annotator\_id

You will enter your annotations here.

Note: The output file is initially empty (except column headers). You must fill in rows for each metaphor you identify.

## What Counts as an Inferential Metaphor?

An **inferential metaphor**:

- Uses language from one domain to describe another.
- Supports reasoning about:
  - Cause
  - Structure
  - Direction
  - System-level relationships
- Helps the reader infer how something works.

Ask yourself: Does this metaphor help explain structure, cause, or relational dynamics?

If yes → include it.

If it is only expressive, emotional, or idiomatic → do NOT include it.

(Review the training packet [here](#) if needed)

## Examples

### ✓ Include

- “The number of bats has plummeted.”
- “Top predators.”
- “Fishing down the food web.”
- “The gene drives development.”
- 

### ✗ Do NOT include

- “Going after predators.”
- “A classroom nightmare.”
- “The city was hit hard.”
- Literal descriptions (“The virus spreads quickly.”)

## Step by Step Instructions

### Step 1 – Open the Input File

For each row:

- Read the `original_sentence` carefully.
- Identify inferential metaphorical expressions.

### Step 2 – Record Each Metaphor in Output Template

For each inferential metaphor:

1. Copy the `slug` from input.
2. Copy the `triplet_id` from input.
  - o Do NOT retype manually.
  - o Use copy-paste to avoid errors.
3. In `metaphor_span`, enter the exact phrase from the text.
  - o Copy the phrase exactly as written.
  - o Do not paraphrase.
4. Enter your initials in `annotator_id`. First two letters of your first name in lower case; no period between letters (example: an)

## Important Rules

- Each metaphor span = **one row**.
- If a passage has 3 inferential metaphors → create 3 rows.
- If a passage has no inferential metaphors → do nothing (no row).
- When unsure → include it and flag it later

## Example Output Row

| slug         | triplet_id        | metaphor_span                                                  | annotator_id |
|--------------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| bat-survival | bat-sufrivial-the | The number of little brown bats has plummeted about 90 percent | an           |

## What not to do

- Do not annotate decorative metaphors
- Do not judge whether meaning is preserved
- Do not modify the template structure
- Do not combine multiple metaphors in one row

## If You Are Unsure

If you encounter an ambiguous case:

- Include the candidate metaphor.
- Add a note in a separate comment file if needed.
- Do not skip uncertain cases.

High recall is preferred at this stage.

## Submission

When finished:

- Save the output template with your initials appended in google folder:
  - o `metaphor_selection_batch_01_1A_output_an.csv`